RESEARCH ARCHIVE / PUBLICATION SYSTEM

FILMMIC FOUNDATIONS

Publication and Design Standard

Research voice · short-film close reading · website design · accessible interfaces · film-analysis PDF production · source verification · machine-readable authoring rules.

Edition 1.0 | Editorial and developer reference

An evidence-led publication standard. The existing film research is a worked example, not a required thesis or fixed outline for future work.

FILMMIC FOUNDATIONS / REFERENCE DOCUMENT

Editorial and design system

Edition 1.0 | Applies to the website, future short-film articles, film-analysis PDFs, and machine-generated content.

Mission. Filmmic Foundations is an anonymous, educational, evidence-led archive of critical analysis of short films. It is not an auteur portfolio, review/rating service, advertiser, fan site, or promotional press kit. Readers should be able to distinguish on-screen evidence, contextual research, critical inference, and unresolved ambiguity. No interpretation is perfectly neutral; the publication aims for transparent, fair, qualified reasoning.

1. Nonnegotiable principles

- **Anonymous publication:** Attribute essays and their scholarly citations to **Filmmic Foundations** unless a genuinely different, explicitly authorized publication credit is provided. Do not identify website owners, repository operators, article drafters, email addresses, internal accounts, private identities, or personal affiliations. Verified filmmakers' names may appear as factual **film credits**, independently of research authorship. Metadata, source images, PDFs, commit identity, and public hosting must be reviewed separately for privacy.
- **Short-film emphasis:** Select films for analytical interest, not their prestige or connection to contributors. Do not implicitly favor particular filmmakers. Articles about any short film may differ substantially in questions, methodology, evidence, and conclusions.
- **Evidence first:** Describe shot, edit, event, character action, sound cue, or line of dialogue accurately before interpreting it. Distinguish 'the film shows' from 'this may suggest'. Do not invent frames, dialogue, scene order, runtime, production stories, audience response, awards, motives, directorial intent, or citations.
- **Analytical—not promotional:** Avoid plot-only retellings, star ratings, evaluative slogans, flattery, marketing language, inflated claims, and declarations of a single 'correct' meaning.
- **Responsible research:** Verify claims with primary film material, credible scholarship, official records, interviews, or appropriately attributed reporting. Always represent study limitations, sample and methods where relevant. Real-world research provides context for an artistic reading, not clinical proof about fictional people.
- **Editorial honesty:** Label uncertain interpretations and alternative readings. Correct substantive errors transparently with updated_date and a note when needed. Do not launder speculation into factual certainty.
- **Accessibility, performance and continuity:** Every page inherits the shared typography, design tokens, navigation, settings, light/dark modes, keyboard behavior, and content accessibility. No new script or

stylesheet should override an established component arbitrarily. Test both desktop and mobile, reduced motion and dark/light modes.

- **No fabricated references:** Every listed reference must exist, be accessible or traceable, and actually support the associated claim. Cite original film as primary text. No placeholders masquerading as real scholarship.

2. Writing voice and rhetorical method

- **Tone:** Precise, observant, reflective, scholarly but readable. Prefer direct verbs and plain explanations over academic padding. Avoid first-person personal autobiography, sarcasm, exaggerated emotional terms, and formulaic AI transitions ("delves into", "testament to", "in today's society").
- **Argument:** Open with an informative abstract stating the film, research question, evidence, central thesis, and boundaries. Structure body sections around concrete questions or cinematic motifs, not a mechanical checklist of every possible filmmaking craft.
- **Analytical paragraph:** (a) verifiable on-screen detail; (b) formal choice (shot, lighting, rhythm, mise-en-scène, sound); (c) plausible effect or thematic function; (d) link to larger argument, scholarly context, or alternative reading; (e) qualification if meaning is ambiguous.
- **Close reading:** Describe composition, focus, camera placement/movement, palette, light, texture, sound, duration, transitions, repetition, production design, casting/performance and narrative construction only where relevant and demonstrable. Refer to evidence the reader can locate in the film.
- **Context:** Connect to psychological, historical, philosophical, technical, or sociological scholarship when appropriate. For sensitive subjects, avoid pathologizing characters or claiming clinical diagnoses based on plot.
- **Alternative readings:** Include plausible interpretations when warranted, and explain why evidence favors or limits a particular reading. Avoid empty "could symbolize anything" claims.
- **Conclusion:** Synthesize interpretive consequences and unresolved questions without overstating filmmaker intention or claiming to prove the theme.
- **Length:** Match depth to research and film complexity, not a rigid word target; an in-depth example is the 16-page Mindglass Procedure PDF. Shorter focused analyses are valid when sources or scenes do not justify longer treatment.

3. Article information architecture

Expected flexible sequence (adapt to the film and argument):

- Descriptive title and, if helpful, critical subtitle (film title visibly identified).
- Film metadata separated from publication metadata: release year, director **when verified**, genre, article publication date, revised date, reading time and publication credit.

- Abstract (~100–200 words as a starting point, not fixed requirement); research question / thesis; methodological disclosure and scope.
- Navigable thematic/formal sections: close analysis with quotations, precise scene descriptions, film stills, captions, original comparative diagrams where meaningful.
- Relevant external context, with accurate citations and boundaries between scholarly evidence and fictional premise.
- Alternative interpretations, uncertainties, evidentiary limits where warranted.
- Conclusion.
- References and further viewing (film first, then contextual sources, consistently formatted).
- **Cite this article** helper after the paper's own references; MLA 9, APA 7, Chicago, IEEE, generated from metadata. This cites the archive's writing, not the film.
- Related research, when related tags/themes/techniques genuinely overlap; omit automatically when no suitable matches.
- Optional film viewing section if legitimate external link exists.

The order of the scholarly body sections is not prescribed. Don't force every paper into a Mindglass Procedure outline. A new film with one striking formal device can justify a tighter focus.

4. Referencing and verification

- Sources: original short film and credited releases; filmmaker interviews/public records for production claims; peer-reviewed studies and authoritative disciplinary works for external context; trustworthy tertiary references only for appropriate factual background.
- Prefer citing exact scene timecodes or precise figure descriptions where feasible; don't invent timestamps.
- Accurate bibliographic data: author, title, publisher/venue, volume/issue/pages, date, DOI/URL, retrieval date only where required by style or mutable source.
- Direct quotations require source and location; paraphrases also need attribution. Avoid extensive unlicensed quotations or stills; check copyright/licensing/fair-use considerations per jurisdiction.
- Source links may go stale: weekly external-link checks assist, but a blocked website is not necessarily a dead reference.
- Publication citation is not evidence that the paper's content is correct. Verify underlying references independently.
- If evidence unavailable, omit the assertion or explicitly state that it is unverified. Do not invent academic publications, statistics, film awards, film festival screenings, or quotations.

5. Visual identity — website

Site name: **FILMMIC FOUNDATIONS**. Calm, editorial, cinematic, restrained; cream paper and deep teal/blue contrast. Distinct from fan and marketing aesthetics.

- **Typography:** DM Sans for navigation, labels, controls, captions; Libre Baskerville for major editorial headings and essay-style passages. Preserve typographic hierarchy; no arbitrary new font families.
- **Core palette (existing CSS is authoritative):** light paper #fcfcfa, ink #18333a, teal accent #2d777d, hairline #dce5e4, deep cinematic panels around #0c1e25. Dark mode uses existing shared theme tokens, not inverted images or untested hardcoded light elements.
- **Layout:** purposeful whitespace, restrained editorial rules, modest radii and shadows, consistent button proportions, no unnecessary colored cards. Home archive supports editorial/gallery/list/compact with stable cover aspect ratios, subtle image scaling, and smooth shape transitions.
- **Navigation:** one global header via assets/css/site-header.css and assets/js/site-settings.js, consistent on Home, About, 404, and article pages; a shared dark-teal article/section toolbar on long-form pages; a floating back-to-top island appears only once scrolled. Footer provides Archive, About, RSS and Developer Portal access.
- **Interactions:** smooth, subtle, reversible entrance/exit animations for dialogs and filters; avoid competing transform/animation declarations on same element. No jumps when switching views; preserve scroll position when opening/closing dialogs.
- **Accessibility:** semantic HTML, descriptive labels for images/buttons, keyboard/focus management, high contrast and reduced-motion preferences, responsive breakpoints including ~320/390/1365 widths. Native and custom interactive components must remain keyboard accessible.
- **Settings:** a shared gear popup supporting theme, font size, line spacing, reading width, motion, citation/PDF preferences, gallery defaults, local reading position, privacy. Store only in local browser storage. Avoid accounts/tracking.
- **Modals:** centered image viewer with Single/Gallery modes, smooth photo transitions and zoom, native download/Share link, background scroll lock; same popup motion language on previews and share dialogs. Controls should stay visible, not stretch imagery or cover navigation unexpectedly.
- **Images:** authentic film stills only, not AI-simulated film frames passed off as originals; meaningful alt text/captions; descriptive lowercase filenames; WebP responsive variants where practical, lazy loading for below-fold assets. Protect photo aspect ratio with object-fit and image transforms rather than stretching.
- **SEO:** unique page descriptions, canonical URLs, OG/Twitter previews, structured schema, RSS, sitemap, full-text search, automatic related-article generation; developer tooling and internal admin URL are excluded from search indexing (not a security boundary).

6. Article PDF design standard

Reference edition: Mindglass Procedure: Memory, Grief, and the Repetition of Avoidance (existing 16-page illustrated 2026 analysis). Treat it as a concrete example, not a rigid template.

Observed reference details from PDF inspection (do not falsely claim these apply to every document): US Letter 612×792 pt; ReportLab-generated; embedded DejaVu Sans and DejaVu Sans Bold; large bold cover title (~30 pt), chapter headings (~12.2 pt), main running prose (~8.9 pt), small captions and running heads (~7–7.6 pt); conservative dark-blue/gray ink on light paper. Fonts on PDFs may differ from the website because reliable embedding and portability take priority. For future long research papers, **larger 10–11 pt text is advisable** when layout permits, rather than shrinking for page count.

PDF requirements:

- Title page: work title, analytical subtitle, film identification/year, synopsis/abstract of scope, one relevant verified still with clear caption, organizational research attribution **Filmmic Foundations**. Filmmaker credits may be included when verified, but don't conflate them with article author.
- Contents page for substantial papers; body headings and bookmarks; page numbers and running header for multi-page works.
- Comfortable margins around 0.65–0.9 in (adjust for design); single-column scholarly prose, paragraphs of reasonable length, page breaks avoiding isolated headings, consistent line height.
- Heading scale, dark-teal accent and muted gray secondary text; editorial minimalism, no decorative panels without explanatory purpose.
- Figures within the narrative at the point they are discussed, figure numbers/captions describing what is shown or compared. Distinguish actual stills from schematic reconstructions. Original diagrams should clarify a relationship, chronology, motif, or contrast, rather than add filler.
- Bibliography / References and Further Viewing with verifiable citations and active DOI/URL links, matching in-text citations. Abstract and method distinct from conclusion. Alternative readings/limitations where material.
- PDF metadata: neutral Title, Author and Creator = Filmmic Foundations; no personal private data, filepaths, software usernames, or private contacts. Strip accidental EXIF/creator annotations. Tagged headings/reading order and descriptive image alternatives wherever tooling supports it.
- Export embed fonts when legal/technically possible, keep selectable text, ensure illustrations are sharp while file size is sensible, verify physical page count/layout at 100% and by rendering pages to images. Avoid a scanned-image-only paper.
- Use the PDF workflow: render → inspect → edit → render → compare; test links, searchable text, typography, page numbering and metadata.

7. Article metadata & asset conventions

<slug>/index.html and <slug>/article.json are mandatory. <slug>/preview.json and a film PDF/images are optional. Slug: lowercase letters/numbers/hyphens, stable once published.

article.json: see ARTICLE_SCHEMA.json for a machine-readable description. Core fields: title, citation_title, description, article_date (YYYY-MM-DD), film_year (4 digits), genre, themes, techniques, tags, image, image_alt, abstract, updated_date, language; include only true supported values.

preview.json can define abstract/gallery images with genuine available local image paths; preview modal must retain correct metadata and layout on mobile and dark mode.

Shared CSS/JS is preferred over duplicating a component in individual articles. Existing scripts/build_archive.py generates listings, publication metadata, citations, sitemap, RSS, search and related research. scripts/quality_gate.py guards structure but **does not fact-check film claims or academic references**.

8. Changes & release checklist

Before a change: inspect the latest successfully published version, identify shared components and constraints, avoid styling one page in isolation. Do not replace existing research or film media unnecessarily.

For every release:

- Change only what is required; avoid duplicate overrides, deprecated scripts, temporary tests, private metadata and unnecessary files.
- Run python3 scripts/build_archive.py, then python3 scripts/quality_gate.py.
- Test Home, About, 404, at least one article; light/dark, 320/390/1365 px, keyboard-only, reduced-motion, footer, settings, filter/view changes, preview, sharing, gallery/zoom/download, citations, PDFs and printing.
- Verify no broken internal/anchor/external links where possible, proper privacy metadata and source attribution.
- Do not claim unrun tests passed; clearly describe any untested browser/platform behavior.
- Preview the diff of any website ZIP before publishing, preserve unrelated prior articles, and back up a known-good deployed version.
- Version the guide when editorial/technical standards change. Make future AI work cite its rule source and flag unsupported claims instead of improvising.

9. AI writing and development instructions

Use AI_AUTHORING_RULES.md and ARTICLE_TEMPLATE.md along with this document. All examples are templates, not verified sources. The AI may suggest a thesis, scene-by-scene framework, and sources to verify, but must not pretend to have seen a film or read a paper it hasn't accessed. Where resources aren't available, produce a research plan or qualified draft with explicit evidence gaps rather than fabricate completion. All publisher-facing author identity remains organizational, not personal.

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Instructions for AI assistants

When asked to create, revise, format, or code a Filmmic Foundations article or website feature:

- Read FILMMIC_FOUNDATIONS_STANDARD.md, PDF_DESIGN_SPEC.md, ARTICLE_SCHEMA.json, and actual current site assets. **Existing code takes precedence over assumed CSS values.**
- The website is an anonymous, educational, evidence-led short-film analysis archive, not a review site or personal portfolio. Article author is **Filmmic Foundations**. Factually verified filmmakers may be named in film credits, never as the publisher's hidden owner.
- Source hierarchy: film itself > official/primary production materials for production facts > peer-reviewed and authoritative context > carefully attributed tertiary descriptions. Never invent research or scenes. Distinguish confirmed film content, contextual scholarship, speculation and metaphor.
- Write in lucid, qualified, specific prose. Avoid generic AI clichés and unsupported psychologizing; distinguish motif, shot, story fact and interpretive claim. State what a source actually reports rather than claiming it proves the film's message.
- Construct a novel, film-specific argument; do not reproduce the Mindglass paper's thesis or structure by default. Use the sample PDF to maintain editorial rigor, captions, and citation discipline, not to force uniform interpretation.
- Preserve short-film focus. Validate film year/director/runtime and original images. Do not invent images represented as genuine stills.
- Generate article HTML, accurate article.json, optional preview.json, images (where licensed) and PDF if requested. The article must have proper sources, metadata, alt text, responsive behavior and publication-level citation helper.
- Follow shared navigation, About standards, page settings, matching toolbar, dark mode, mobile/keyboard/reduced-motion and popup behavior. Do not create duplicate files/classes for components that already exist.
- All PDF files: selectable text, appropriately embedded fonts, labeled figures, verified sources, neutral embedded metadata, sensible page sizes, rendered inspection before delivery.
- For code changes check baseline screenshots, conflicts, build output, automated validator and browser interactions, and clearly report tests not performed. Minimize diff; include only source/site assets needed for publishing.
- Related articles match overlapping themes/techniques, not merely common genre. Don't fabricate recommendations or publication statistics.

- Publish never without explicit administrator action; admin ZIP gate (123 demo) is not security. Do not store secrets in static JavaScript or commit them in ZIPs. GitHub authorization must be separate.

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Film-analysis PDF specification

Reference example: 16-page Mindglass Procedure: Memory, Grief, and the Repetition of Avoidance. See Publication Standard §6 for measured values.

Design and production

- US Letter (612 × 792 pt) is an established baseline, not an inviolable rule.
- Restrained academic typographic hierarchy, uncluttered light paper, deep-blue ink, muted teal separators, concise running heads and page numbers.
- Main body text should prioritize comfortable readability (~10–11pt preferred where feasible). Existing sample uses approximately 8.9pt for dense text; do not blindly clone that small size.
- Consistent paragraph rhythm, no orphan headings, clear section hierarchy. Use the paper's actual argument to determine section breaks and pacing.
- Professional cover: title, film, essay subtitle, accurate verified film still and caption, anonymous organizational author. Multi-page papers usually include a table of contents and abstract/scope.
- Clearly differentiated film stills vs original analytical diagrams, numbered figures with factual captions. Place illustrations near relevant text. Preserve original aspect ratio.
- References: original film as primary source, other research with verified citation details. Every sourced assertion must be traceable; bibliography does not prove content.
- Font embedding or accessible equivalent; selectable text, active links, logical reading order; publication author metadata Filmmic Foundations only. Scan for identifying metadata.
- Render every page to image, manually inspect, compare edits; verify full page count, margins, no clipped captions or broken links.

Writing and interpretation

- Film-specific research question and nuanced central claim.
- Scene-level observation plus filmmaking technique plus argued meaning plus evidence/qualification.
- Real-world sources provide conceptual context; do not use science to diagnose fictional people or claim invented technologies are established practice.
- Treat ambiguity as ambiguity, include alternative readings and limitations where relevant.

Future PDF authoring workflow

- Verify source film, scenes and reference bibliography.
- Draft with explicit figure placements, labels and full references.
- Lay out publication-consistent paper.
- Embed fonts, links and neutral document metadata; remove accidental creator identity.
- Render to images, inspect and revise all pages.
- Test links, selectable text and accessibility properties.

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Research article template

Publication author: Filmmic Foundations

Short film: [Verified film title] ([Verified release year]) **Film credits:** [Verified director(s) and other relevant craft credits] **Working research question:** [Precise question relating form and meaning] **Provisional thesis:** [Interpretive claim; label unconfirmed readings] **Publication date:** [YYYY-MM-DD] **Sources reviewed:** [Actual film, interviews, scholarly sources read] **Evidence not yet verified:** [Explicit list]

Abstract

[100–200 words as a guide. Name the film, central formal evidence, thesis, method and limits. No unsupported claims.]

Method and scope

[The film as primary text; frame, timing, sound and sources available; limitations and possible missing materials.]

[Film-specific argument I]

[Observed shot/sequence/line. How the shot/lighting/editing/sound works. Interpretive consequences. Supporting scholarship if relevant. Figure/citation.]

[Film-specific argument II]

[Follow the strongest evidence; don't force a set number of sections.]

Contextual scholarship

[What each actual author says, methods/limitations, why relevant but not a proof of the film's fictional universe.]

Alternative interpretations and limitations

[Meaningful alternatives, unverified production facts, uncertainty.]

Conclusion

[Synthesis, implications and open questions.]

References and further viewing

[Film first, scholarly/primary research thereafter. Verify full citations and links.]

Cite this article

[Generated automatically from validated article.json, **not** typed manually.]

Assets and metadata checklist

- Verified cover and stills with descriptive alt text and captions
- Optional meaningful diagram vs. decorative filler
- article.json / preview.json and actual film year separate from article date
- PDF reviewed as text and rendered pages; neutral metadata
- Build and quality gate pass; mobile/dark/keyboard check

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Release and verification checklist

- [ ] Original short-film title, year, credits, runtime and media availability verified.
- [ ] Each analysis distinguishes direct observation, interpretation, scholarly context and uncertainties.
- [ ] Specific scene/shot/sound details are checked against the source film; no invented dialogue or quotes.
- [ ] Sources exist, support claims, are attributed and cited correctly; film is cited as primary text.
- [ ] Editorial tone is clear, restrained, nonpromotional; significant alternative readings addressed when relevant.
- [ ] No personal research author or owner identity; embedded PDF/image metadata and git attribution reviewed.
- [ ] All stills are authentic, permission/use considered, descriptive, proportional, labeled and accessible.
- [ ] Article HTML includes title, abstract, references, proper figure numbering, no duplicate controls.
- [ ] Structured metadata valid; article publication date distinct from film release year.
- [ ] PDF generated (if provided), fonts/selectable text/figure captions/page numbers checked visually and metadata stripped.
- [ ] Shared header, toolbar, Settings, About, 404, footers work consistently.
- [ ] Desktop/mobile: 320/390/1365 widths; light/dark, keyboard, contrast and reduced motion.
- [ ] Archive search, filtering, four layouts, previews, related matching and RSS verified.
- [ ] Image zoom, download, gallery, share, PDF/new-tab behavior, citations and footers verified.
- [ ] No unnecessary dependency, script, CSS override, secret, personal data, temporary image or cache.
- [ ] python3 scripts/build_archive.py and python3 scripts/quality_gate.py succeed.
- [ ] Every uploaded ZIP diff inspected, backup identified, GitHub deployment status checked.